

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA, CONTRA COSTA COUNTY
MARTINEZ, CA
DEPARTMENT 32
JUDICIAL OFFICER: JONI T HIRAMOTO
HEARING DATE: 09/18/2026

ALL APPEARANCES WILL BE BY ZOOM.

The tentative ruling will become the Court's ruling unless, by 4:00 p.m. of the court day preceding the hearing, counsel or self-represented parties

EMAIL THE DEPARTMENT at dept32@contracosta.courts.ca.gov to request argument and
SPECIFY THE ISSUES to be argued.

Counsel or self-represented parties requesting argument must advise all other affected counsel and self-represented parties by no later than 4:00 p.m. of his or her intention to appear and of the issues to be argued.

Failure to timely advise the Court and counsel or self-represented parties will preclude any party from arguing the matter. (Local Rule 3.43(2).)

CourtCall will **NOT** be used by D32.

Zoom is approved for all hearings except Issue Conferences and Trials.

Dept. 32's telephone number is: (925) 608-1132.

Dept. 32's email address is: dept32@contracosta.courts.ca.gov.

Submission of Orders After Hearing in Department 32 Cases

The prevailing party must prepare an order after hearing in accordance with CRC 3.1312. The order must include appearances. If the tentative ruling becomes the Court's ruling, a copy of the Court's tentative ruling **must be attached to the proposed order** when submitted to the Court for issuance of the order.

Zoom hearing information

[https://contracosta-courts-](https://contracosta-courts-ca.zoomgov.com/j/1613360625?pwd=pSvwmR75t9Q2H5zOgagi9rbG4xeTUM.1)
[ca.zoomgov.com/j/1613360625?pwd=pSvwmR75t9Q2H5zOgagi9rbG4xeTUM.1](https://contracosta-courts-ca.zoomgov.com/j/1613360625?pwd=pSvwmR75t9Q2H5zOgagi9rbG4xeTUM.1)

Meeting ID: 161 336 0625

Passcode: 180770

Law & Motion

1. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C22-01571
CASE NAME: JANE DOE VS. CONTRA COSTA BALLET CENTRE, AN ENTITY OF UNKNOWN TYPE
HEARING ON SUMMARY MOTION
FILED BY: CONTRA COSTA BALLET CENTRE
TENTATIVE RULING:

The Court on its own motion continues this hearing to October 16, 2026, at 9:00 a.m.

2. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C23-00131
CASE NAME: MADELINE SERAFIN VS. ROBERT SERAFIN
***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: MOTION TO LIFT STAY ON DISCOVERY FILED 8/17/26 BY MADELINE SERAFIN**
FILED BY: SERAFIN, MADELINE
TENTATIVE RULING:

Plaintiff's motion to lift the stay on Discovery is granted. Parties may pursue discovery [1] exclusive of issues determined by the Family Court's Final Statement of Decision filed August 31, 2026, in Contra Costa County Case No. MSD21-02739, and [2] that is not related to the Burden note and related instruments, which are the subject of the case in federal court.

3. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C23-01988
CASE NAME: MATTHEW PARRY VS. GELCO FLEET TRUST
***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: TO FILE CERTAIN RECORDS WITH REDACTIONS AND CERTAIN RECORDS COMPLETELY UNDER SEAL**
FILED BY: MERCEDES-BENZ USA, LLC
TENTATIVE RULING:

Before the Court is the motion of Defendant Mercedes-Benz USA, LLC (MBUSA or Defendant) for an order search Exhibits 10 and 41-1, and redacting personal information from Exhibits 27-2 and 38-2 (all attached to the Declaration of Alan Van Gelder in Opposition to MBUSA's Motion for Summary Judgment (Van Gelder Decl.)).

There are four documents at issue.

Ex.	Request	Description
38-2 to Van Gelder Decl., Ex. A to Brunner Decl.	Redaction only	MBUSA internal questionnaire with customer responses regarding a specific reported incident, which is not the subject of this lawsuit. Identifies the reporting customer's name and acronym of the customer's business. Provided to MBUSA through its direct customer assistance service. Information is maintained by MBUSA as confidential in ordinary course of business. Produced unredacted to Plaintiff pursuant to "Pioneer letter" notifying customer of disclosure to plaintiff's attorneys but not notifying of "public disclosure." Brunner Decl, ¶ 7a. Previously produced to Plaintiff in another litigation matter, Wolf